

Blue Yeti Nano

Blue Yeti Nano is the latest addition to Blue's Yeti line of microphones, and their most affordable option, yet.

The Blue Yeti Nano is a USB desktop condenser microphone which comes with two polar patterns, cardioid and omnidirectional. While the cardioid pattern is good for picking up audio from a single direction, the omnidirectional pattern is good for picking up sounds from all directions. Also, with the Yeti Nano one needs to keep in mind that you have to speak at the Nano from the sides, rather than from the top.

On the mic body, you have a headphone monitoring volume dial,



and you can also choose the pickup pattern of your choice from here (i.e., cardioid, or omnidirectional). Pushing down on the dial mutes the mic, and the light turns red when muted. In terms of ports, you've got a 3.5mm headphone jack for live monitoring, and a microUSB port which is used to connect to a computer.

The Blue Yeti Nano misses out on only a few features that are present in the more top-of-the-line Yeti mics; for instance, the presence of more polar patterns.

Aimed at budding streamers, the Nano is a simple plug-and-play microphone. Of course, it's not just streamers; budding podcasters, or anyone really who's looking to improve their mic quality, be it for work-from-home calls or even gaming, the Blue Yeti Nano is an option. We've been using the microphone ourselves for a few days and it performs quite admirably for its segment, producing crisp and clear audio. Even when it's digitally modulated or enhanced later, it provides a very clean sound. The design and overall style factor is a huge bonus, giving it a nice balance of form, aesthetics and utility.

PRICE: ₹8,995

XGIMI Halo+

Thinking of projectors generally brings to mind a huge bulky object that needs a lot of power, heats up considerably, and requires a lot of adjustment before one can get started with viewing whatever it is that they wanted to view. Quite a few projector manufacturers have tried to solve a lot of the above problems and have even found success. However, if there's one projector that's managed to do a better job than others, then that is the XGIMI Halo+.

This little gizmo is a battery-operated portable projector which is designed to work everywhere. It even has an Android distribution system baked in to make it a smart projector. All you need is good internet. Most of the projector would be the battery so it is a little heavy, but nowhere close to traditional projectors.

The unit comes in an easy-to-carry bag which has a separate compartment for the remote. On the bottom of the Halo+ is a little flip tab that opens up to allow adjusting the pitch of the device. There's even a 1/4-inch tripod mount if you're really particular about getting a proper projection. Speaking of which, there's

an automated keystone adjustment feature that kicks in the moment the Halo+ feels that it has been placed on stable ground. Moving the projector will cause the keystone adjustment to readjust. It's that convenient.

All the I/O is on the rear with options for connecting a 3.5 mm audio out, HDMI in and USB in. The rear also houses the exhaust vents. The front and sides seem to house two 5 Watt Harman Kardon speakers and they do manage to sound decent in a closed environment. Outdoors is an entirely different ball-game. The bulb on the Halo+ is capable of outputting 900 Lumens which might not sound that high but considering how small the device is, it's quite bright in its class.

On the software side of things, the Halo+ comes

with Android 10 OS and the usual assortment of OTT apps can be easily installed. The only exception is Netflix which seems to be held back because of some certification issues but you can always sideload the Kodi edition of the Netflix app and get around this minor inconvenience.

The XGIMI Halo+ is one impressive cookie considering all the features that they've managed to pack into the unit. The price tag might seem a little on the higher side but it's well worth the money.

PRICE: ₹99,999

